IMPERIAL

Hackathon

Hong Kong & Macau 2026

Online Briefing

Agenda:

1. An overview of Imperial Hackathon
2. Meet the Judges
3. This year's 6 Challenges
4. What are the Judges looking for?
5. What makes a team stand out?
6. How to give a great pitch
7. Live Q&A



Housekeeping

Schedule

The event is scheduled to last for 60 minutes, with presentations by the judges, followed by a live interactive Q&A.

Q&A

You can ask questions via Teams throughout the event. We will publish relevant ones and answer as many as possible either in chat or the live Q&A. If watching the recording, please email questions to imperialhackathon@imperial.ac.uk

Event Recording

The event is being recorded and will be available to watch shortly after the webinar has ended.

IMPERIAL

What is the Imperial Hackathon?

Real-Word Impact

Evidence-based challenges inspired by policy priorities in both cities

Cross-Border Teams

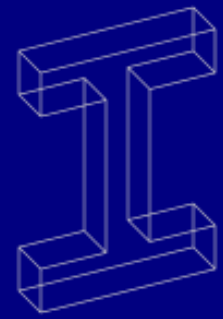
For the first time, Imperial Hackathon welcomes participants from both Hong Kong and Macau, to tackle shared regional challenges

Two competition tracks

Secondary school (Years 10-12) and university/early career participants

Six Challenge options

Five themed challenges plus an Open Challenge, tailored to each track

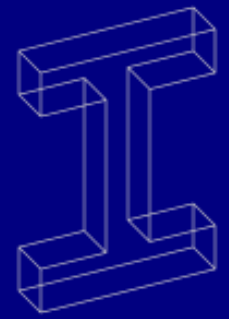


Think across disciplines. Create solutions that matter

GRAND FINAL - SATURDAY 14 NOVEMBER 2026 - HONGKONG

Meet the Judges

Dr Jackie Bell, Professor Shahid Khan, Dr Pamela Tin, Helen Kwok





Dr Jackie Bell is an award-winning Principal Teaching Fellow at Imperial College London and an Honorary Fellow of the University of Liverpool. With a PhD in theoretical particle physics, she specialises in Equity, Diversity and Inclusion in STEM, championing underrepresented groups and widening participation in higher education. She received Imperial's President's Medal for Supporting the Student Experience in 2024 and was selected for the BBC's *Astronauts: Do You Have What It Takes?* programme.



Professor Shahid A Khan is Professor of Practice (Hepatology) and Director of Admissions at Imperial College London and an NHS Consultant Hepatologist and Gastroenterologist at Imperial College Healthcare NHS Trust. An internationally recognised expert in liver diseases and biliary cancer, he has contributed to national and international clinical guidelines, plays a senior role in national clinical trials in liver disease, and has authored over 100 peer-reviewed publications. He currently chairs Cholangiocarcinoma UK and serves on several national clinical and advisory committees.



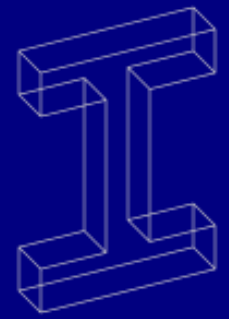
Dr Pamela Tin is Research Director at the Chief Executive's Policy Unit (CEPU) of the Hong Kong Government, where she leads evidence-based research to inform future policy development. Holding a PhD in public health, she previously led award-winning health policy research at a leading Hong Kong think tank. She has also served on the HKSAR Government's Advisory Committee on Mental Health.



Helen Kwok is Digital Strategy Lead at Google Hong Kong, specialising in digital advertising and cross-border business strategy. She previously led regional advertising sales at Xiaohongshu (Rednote) and gained experience in enterprise technology at Amazon Web Services (AWS). Combining expertise in digital marketing, technology and business growth, she helps emerging businesses develop effective market strategies and expand across the region

This Year's Challenges

Overview of all five challenges and the open challenge



Challenge 1 — Agetech GBA: smart ageing technology for Hong Kong and Macau

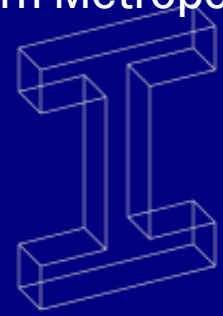
Challenge 2 — Responsible AI GBA: trustworthy AI for public services including the new AI City Brain

Challenge 3 — Green Greater Bay: green technology and decarbonisation for the GBA

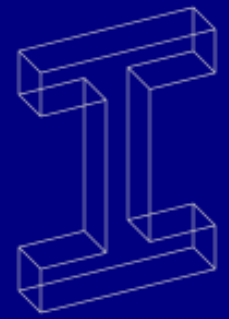
Challenge 4 — Healthbridge GBA: TCM and biomedical convergence for high-burden diseases

Challenge 5 — Future Hub: Smart infrastructure, drone applications, and development in the Northern Metropolis.

Challenge 6 — Open challenge: teams define their own policy-grounded problem



What are the Judges looking for?

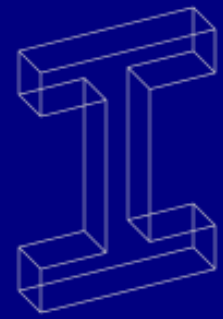


What are judges are looking for?

- Teams that understand their problem as well as their solution
- Vision clearly presented to time limits
- Teams that are honest about any limitations and don't oversell
- Good teamworking, with every team member able to speak to their contribution
- Solutions that could realistically exist in Hong Kong or Macau
- Teams that answer questions directly, rather than deflecting

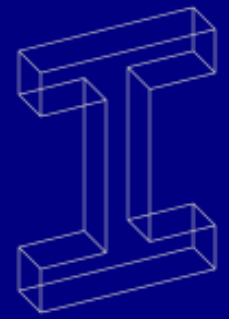
What does not impress judges?

- Technically impressive solutions that do not address a real need
- Polished pitches with no substance behind them
- Solutions that ignore the human or ethical dimension entirely
- Teams where only one person can answer questions



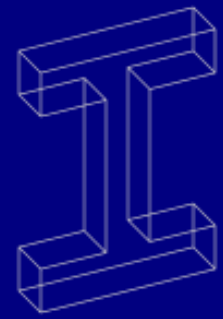
What makes a team stand out?

Tips from the Judges



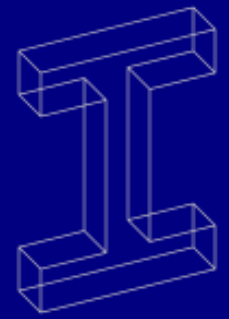
What makes a team stand out?

- **Design for real people:** solutions that are accessible, inclusive and usable by a wide range of people, not just a niche audience.
- **Focus on practical and long-term impact:** ideas that can realistically be adopted, scaled, or implemented beyond the hackathon.
- **Build something tangible (if possible):** a prototype, mock-up, demo, or proof of concept helps brings ideas to life.
- **Learn and adapt:** teams that listen to feedback, respond thoughtfully to questions, and are willing to refine their ideas as they learn more.
- **Balance ambition with feasibility:** creative ideas backed by a realistic plan for implementation.
- **Show genuine enthusiasm:** teams that enjoy the challenge often communicate their ideas more convincingly.



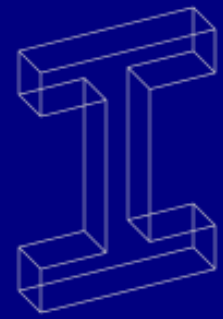
How to give a great pitch

Tips from the Judges



What makes a great pitch?

- **Start with the human story** – make us care about the problem before you explain the technology.
- **Show why it matters** – help the audience understand the scale, urgency, or consequences of the challenge.
- **Make it relatable** – use real-world examples, scenarios, or user journeys that people can connect with.
- **Back up your claims with evidence** – use data, research, or user insights to support both the problem and your solution.
- **Show your solution in action** – demonstrations and prototypes are often more memorable than descriptions.
- **Be clear and concise** – every minute should reinforce your key message.
- **End with a compelling vision** – leave judges with a clear picture of the future your solution could create.



IMPERIAL

Hackathon

Hong Kong & Macau 2026

Any Questions?